KONGUNADU COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING AND TECHNOLOGY
(AUTONOMOUS)
NAMAKKAL- TRICHY MAIN ROAD, THOTTIAM, TRICHY
DEPARTMENT OF ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCES AND DATA SCIENCE
20MC002 & UNIVERSAL HUMAN VALUES 2: UNDERSTANDING HARMONY
HANDOUTS

UNIT-1 Introduction to Value Education

Meaning of Value Education:

Value Education is the education which enables to understand 'what is valuable' for human happiness. It is all about enabling a transformation in the human beings to help them move from Animal Consciousness to Human Consciousness.

Need for Value Education:

- Correct identification of our aspirations
- Understanding universal human values to fulfill our aspirations in continuity
- Complementarity of values and skills
- Evaluation of our beliefs
- Technology and human values

Basic Guidelines for Value Education:

- Universal
- Rational
- Natural and Verifiable
- All Encompassing
- Leading to Harmony

Scope of Value Education:

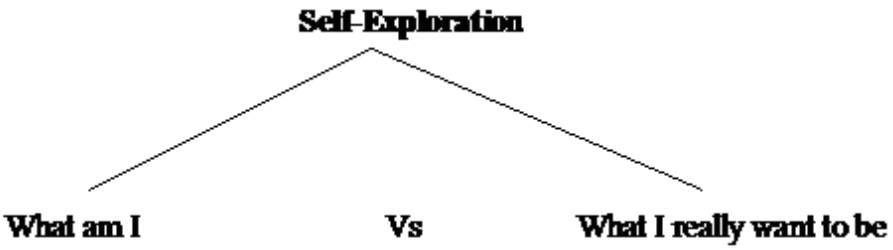
- It should include all dimensions of thought, behaviour, work and realization
- It should include all the four levels of human living namely – individual, family, society and nature.

Content of Value Education:

- To understand myself, my aspirations, my happiness
- To understand the goal of human life
- To understand the other entities in nature, their inter- connectedness and co-existence and role of human being in nature
- To understand harmony at the four levels of human living

Process of Value Education:

Value Education begins with Self-Exploration i.e. looking inside yourself.



Self-Exploration:
It is the process of finding out what is valuable to me by investigating within myself.
Exploration = Observing Outside
Self-Exploration = Observing Inside

Purpose of Self-Exploration:

- It is a process of dialogue between 'what you are' and 'what you really want to be'.
- It is a process of self evolution through self-investigation.
- It is a process of knowing oneself and through that, knowing the entire existence.
- It is a process of recognizing one's relationship with every unit in existence and fulfilling it.
- It is a process of knowing human conduct, human character and living accordingly.
- It is a process of being in harmony with oneself and in harmony with entire existence.
- It is a process of identifying our innateness(Svatva) and moving towards Self-Organization(Swantantrata) and Self-Expression(Swarajya)

Content of Self-Exploration:
It involves finding answers for the following –

- My Desire (Aspiration)
- My Program (Process to fulfill my aspirations)

Process of Self-Exploration:
<u>The following points are to be kept in mind regarding the process of Self-Exploration:</u>

- Whatever is stated is a proposal
- Don't start by assuming it to be true or false
- Verify it on your own right
- Don't just accept or reject it on the basis of scriptures, instruments or on the basis of others.
- The following two steps are involved in the process of Self-Exploration**:**

- Firstly, verify the proposal on the basis of your natural acceptance
- Secondly, live according to the proposal to validate it experientially.

Natural Acceptance: It is the process of seeing and observing attentively and then using your inner conscience to get the answer from within. It is a way to bring out the goodness in everything naturally.

- It does not change with time/age
- It doesn't depend on place

- It does not depend on our beliefs or past conditioning
- It is always there within us
- It is the same for all of us.

Realization and Understanding:
The process of Self-Exploration results in 'Realization' and 'Understanding' in us. This realization and understanding leads to the following answers –

- Assuring
- Satisfying
- Universal with respect to Time, Space and Individual.

All human beings basically aspire for/ want the following in their life:

i. Continuous Happiness
ii. Prosperity

- If all of us happen to prepare a list of our aspirations, we will find that all our aspirations have an underlying basic desire – the basic aspiration to be happy. Through his life, every human being is continuously trying to do things that make him/her happy. In other words, we always look for continuous happiness in our life.
- In addition to happiness, we also aspire for adequate fulfillment of our bodily needs i.e. the need for physical facilities. These Physical Facilities are the material things we use in order to fulfill the needs of our body. Having enough physical facilities gives us a feeling of prosperity. We want to have a continuity of this feeling too. Hence prosperity is another basic aspiration of every human being.

Exploring Happiness and Prosperity:
Happiness: Happiness may be defined as being in harmony/ synergy in the states/ situations that we live in. Happiness is being in a state of liking. Unhappiness is a lack of this synergy or harmony. To be in a state of disliking is unhappiness.
Happy situations comprise of feelings such as trust, respect, confidence etc. All these feelings carry an element of harmony in them. Hence they make us feel relaxed and happy.
On the other hand, feelings like failure, disrespect, lack of confidence, doubt etc. lack the element of harmony and hence make us unhappy.
Prosperity: It is the feeling of having more physical facilities than required. Prosperity creates a desire to share what one possesses. However, since the need for physical facilities is limitless, the feeling of prosperity cannot be assured.
Wealth: Wealth is a physical thing. It means having money, or having a lot of physical facilities, or having both.
Prosperity Vs Wealth: Wealth means possessing more number of physical things while Prosperity is a feeling of possessing more than required physical facilities.

<u>The false notions of happiness and Prosperity have affected human living at all four levels:</u>
At the level of Individual: Problems of depression, psychological disorders, suicides, stress, insecurity, psycho-somatic diseases, loneliness etc.
At the level of family: Breaking of Joint families, mistrust, conflict between older and younger generations, insecurity in relationships, divorce, dowry tortures, family feuds, wasteful expenditures in family functions etc.

At the level of Society: Terrorism, naxalism, communism, casteism, racial, ethnic struggles, wars between nations, genocide, nuclear genetic warfare.
At the level of Nature: Global Warming, pollution, depletion of mineral resources, deforestation, loss of soil fertility.

The three basic requirements to ensure happiness and prosperity for human beings are –

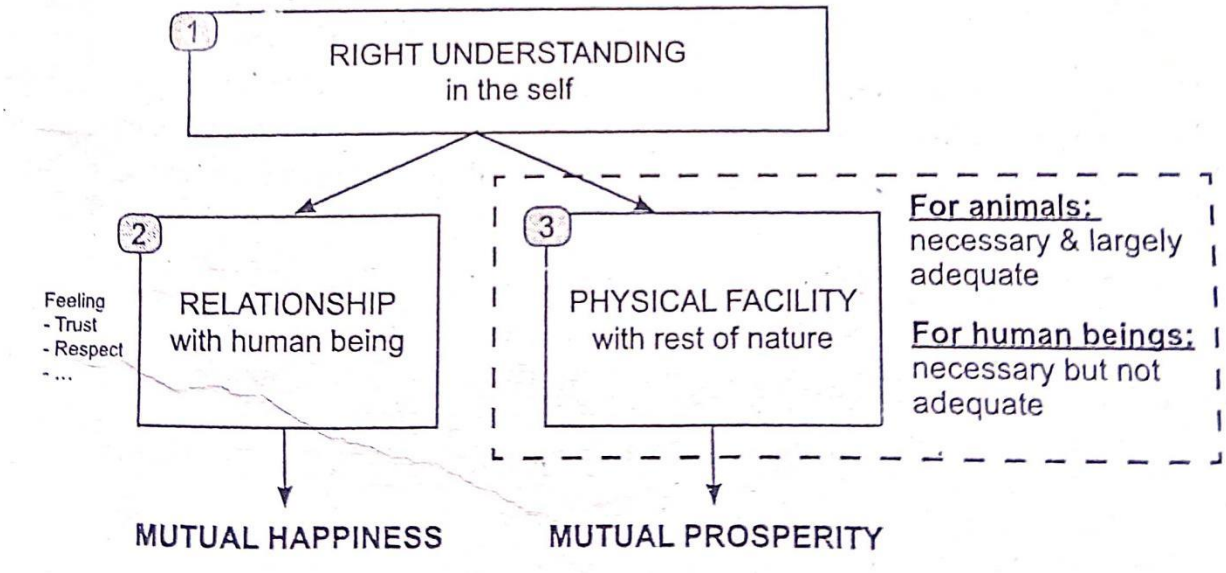
i. Right Understanding
ii. Relationships
iii. Physical Facilities

(Living only with Physical Facilities is Animal Consciousness and living with all these three is Human Consciousness)
In the modern times, we are mostly not paying attention to(i) and (ii) and are focusing largely on (iii) most of the time. As human beings, all the three are needed for us.

Importance/ Need for Right Understanding:
Right Understanding helps to create harmony at all four levels of human living. Right Understanding enables us to –

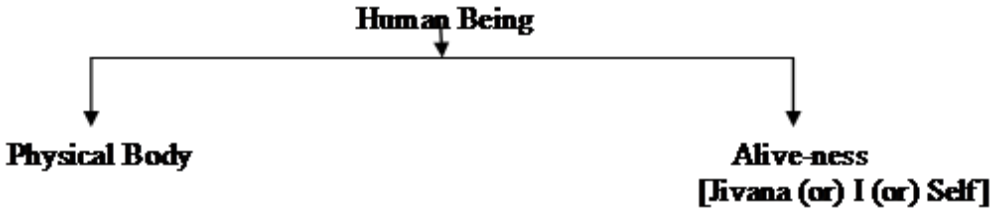
- Resolve the issues in human relationships
- Be prosperous
- Enrich Nature
- Work out our requirements for physical facilities
- Correctly distinguish between wealth and prosperity
- Understand the harmony in Nature

Right Understanding forms the basis on which we can work for relationships and also acquire Physical Facilities.



UNIT-2 Harmony in the Human Being

Human being is more than just a Body. He is a co-existence of both the Self(I/ Jivana) and the Body. There is an exchange of information between the two. Our body acts according to the suggestions given by our "Jivana".



All the human feelings of happiness, sorrow, pain, excitement etc. are all experienced by "I" and not the "Body".

		I	BODY
		Trust, Respect…	Food, Clothing…
Needs	Needs are….	Happiness (Sukh)	Physical Activities (Suvidha)
	In terms of Time, needs are…	Continuous	Temporary
	In terms of Quantity, needs are…	Qualitative (no quantity)	Quantitative (limited in quantity)
Activities	Needs are fulfilled by….	Right Understanding and Right Feelings	Food, clothing etc.
	Activities are…	Desiring, thinking, etc.	Breathing, heart-beat etc.
Type	It is of Type…	Knowing, assuming, recognizing, fulfilling Conscious (non-material)	Recognizing, fulfilling Physico-chemical (material)

Understanding the Body as an instrument of "I":
("I" being the Seer, Doer and Enjoyer)

1. "I" am. The "Body" is.
- "I" knows I exist. I am a conscious / sentient entity.
- The "Body" doesn't know. It is a material entity.

2. "I" want to live. The "Body" is my instrument.
- "I" and my "Body" co-exist with each other.
- "I" takes decisions and the "Body" acts accordingly.

3. "I" want to live in Continuous Happiness. For my happiness, the Body needs Physical Facilities.

- For the "I" to enjoy the feelings of Strength and Health, my body needs food.
- To get the feeling of protection, my body needs clothing and shelter.
- To utilize my Body (Right Utilization of the body), I need various instruments, equipments etc. With the help of these, my body can make me feel happy.

4. My ('I') program for Continuous Happiness is to understand and to live in harmony at all the four levels. To fulfill my('I') program of achieving Continuous Happiness, the Body is provided with Physical Facilities.

- Ensuring Physical Facilities to the body consists of Production, Protection and Right Utilization.
- **Example:** Producing Wheat, Protecting the wheat from extreme climate and pests, Right Utilization through proper consumption like avoiding wastage etc.
- Today, we have ignored the "I", we know only of the existence of the "Body" and we are only aiming at having more and more Physical Facilities. These facilities do not ensure good health, happiness or the right understanding in "I". Hence we should all pay urgent attention to include the program for "I".

5. I am the Seer, I am the Doer and I am the Enjoyer.

I am the Seer

Behind all our activities of our Seeing, Understanding, Doing and Enjoying is a feeling of "I-ness" with which we identify ourselves. Every human being actually participates in a number of such activities everyday. In all these activities, the body acts only as an instrument. It is the "I" that sees or understands something.

For e.g.: Our eyes and ears act as instruments which help us to see or listen anything. They do not convey any any information. It is the "I" that understands what it has seen or listened to.

"Seer" also means the one who understands.

Hence I am the Seer (Drasta).

I am the Doer

Once I have seen and understood something, I decide what I should/ should not do. I take the help of my body parts to accomplish the task I want to do.

For e.g.: I use my hands to write, my legs to walk etc. My body works as per the instructions given by me. Hence I am the Doer and I express my actions via my body.

Doer means "one who does" or "the one who takes decisions to do something".

Hence I am the Doer (Karta).

I am the Enjoyer

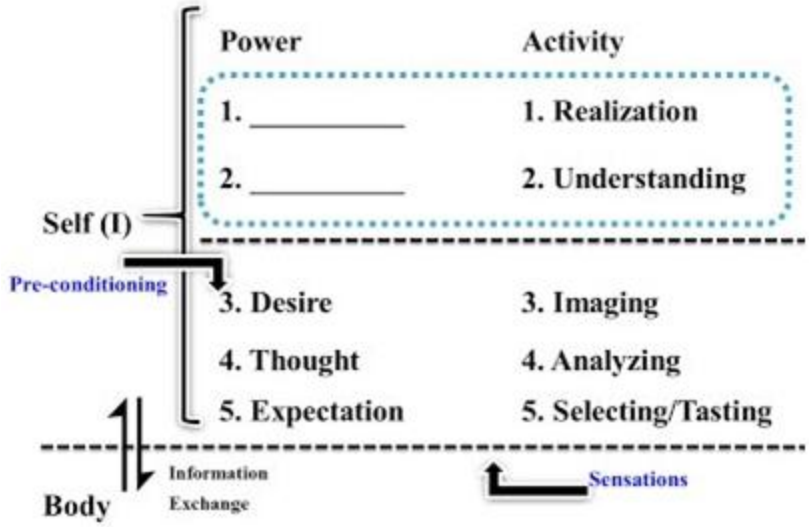
I use my body as an instrument to perform various activities. It is I who enjoy the pleasure derived out of those activities.

For e.g.: mouth helps to chew and the tongue to taste, but I enjoy the taste and flavour. I am the one feeling excited, angry, sad, happy etc. my body is only one instrument.

Enjoyer means "one who enjoys".

Hence I am the Enjoyer (Bhokta).

Activities in Self (I):



Analysis of the above diagram:

- The Self "I" is conscious in nature while the "Body" is physio-chemical in nature. The interaction between 'I' and the 'Body' is in the form of exchange of information.
- The diagram shows two categories of attributes of the Self, namely, the powers of the Self (Sakti) and the corresponding Activities (Kriyas) as the manifest outcome of these powers.

POWER: This is the basic capacity in the Self "I". This includes:

- Desire (Ichchha)
- Thought (Vichara / Vichar)
- Expectation (Asa / Asha)

ACTIVITIES: These are the outcomes of the power of Self. They are-

- Imaging (Chitrana / Chitran)
- Analyzing (Vishleshana)
- Selecting / Tasting (Chayana / Asvadana)

The activities of Realization and Understanding: These are the two activities in the Self.

Realization: It means to be able to see the reality as it is.

Understanding: It means to be able to understand the self-organization in all entities of Nature/Existence and their inter-connectedness at all the levels of our living.

Space

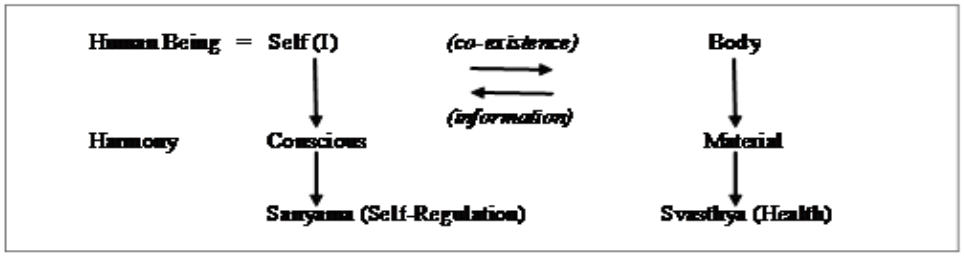
	Dynamic Activity	State Activity	
Self	1. Authentication	Realization (B1)	Co-existence
	2. Determination	Understanding	Harmony in Nature
	3. Imaging	Contemplation	Participation in Larger Order, Relationship
	4. Analysing	Comparing (B2)	Co-existence, Harmony, Justice *guided* Sensation, Health, Profit
	5. Selecting	Tasting	Goal, Value *guided* Sensation
Body	Behaviour	Work	Participation
Other	Human	Rest of Nature	in larger Order

Harmony of the "I" with the Body:

The harmony of "I" with the body is:

i. In the form of Sanyama (Self-Regulation) on part of "I

ii. In the form of Svasthya (Health) on part of the Body

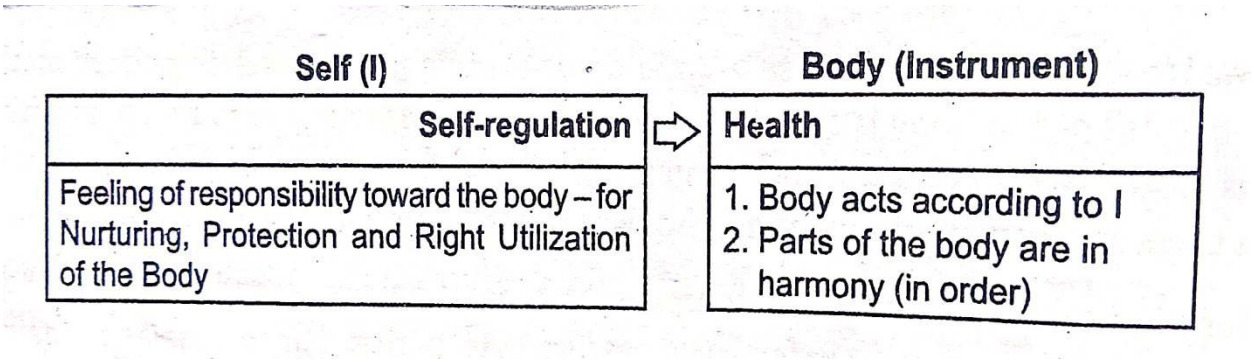


Sanyama(Self-Regulation):

It is the feeling of responsibility in the Self ("I") for nurturing, protection and right utilization of the Body. Once I realize that the Body is my instrument and that the body needs nutrition, protection from the environment and proper utilization to work as an efficient tool for the right purpose, I naturally develop a feeling of responsibility towards my Body. This feeling of responsibility developed in "I" is Sanyama. When I live with Sanyama, there is harmony among the different parts of the Body and the Body becomes my useful instrument.

Svasthya (Health):

It is the condition of the body where every part of the body is properly performing its expected function. This leads to harmony within the body, and the body become perfectly fit for use by the "I". There is a strong coupling between "I" and the "Body". Disharmony in any one of them adversely affects the other.



Program for self-regulation:

<u>Nurturing of the Body (Posana / Poshan):</u>

Posana / Poshan involves providing proper food **(Ahar)**, air, water etc. to the body.
The selection of food (Ahar) should be such that it gives required nutrients and energy to the body following the program below**:**

- **Ingestion:** This involves taking the food into the mouth and chewing it well for easy digestion.
- **Digestion:** Digestion starts after swallowing the food. Digestion also depends on proper rest and exercise of the body. Food consumed should be at proper intervals and with proper posture and right quantity.
- **Excretion:** After digestion, the necessary nutrients are absorbed by the body and the unnecessary or undigested part needs to be thrown out or excreted.

If any of the above three activities are not performed properly, it affects the body adversely and causes several health problems.

<u>Protection of the Body (Sanrakshana):</u>

This involves the selection of proper clothes and shelter for protecting the body from extreme climatic conditions and to provide the right amount of exposure of the body to air, water, sunlight etc. to ensure proper functioning of the body.

Right Utilization of the Body (Sadupayoga)

It is normally believed that our body is an instrument for sensory enjoyment. This is a wrong notion. We also use our body to exploit others and to exploit Nature as well.
For e.g.: fighting, sealing, quarrelling etc.

Human Body should be used only for the right behaviour and right work. Otherwise it leads to disharmony in the Self which has adverse affects on the Body.

We should arrange for appropriate equipments/ physical facilities which help the right utilization of the body and avoid excess physical labour.

UNIT-3 Harmony in the Family and Society

Family is the Basic Unit of all Interaction: Each of us is born into a family which includes a number of relationships. These relationships are the reality of our life. We recognize and identify these individuals. We share our feelings, tastes, interests and understanding with these people and have an affinity for them.

Beginning with our family as the basic unit of interaction, we extend our interactions to the immediate neighbourhood such as the shopkeepers, servants, classmates, teachers, colleagues etc. Thus we extend our interactions from beginning from our family to a bigger social order and then move further to a still bigger web of interdependency.

Set of proposals to verify Harmony in the Family:

1. Relationship IS and it exists between the Self ('I') and the other Self ('I'): In a family, we do not create relationships. Instead we are embedded into relationships that are already there and all that we need to do is to recognize them and understand them.

2. The Self ('I') has feelings in a relationship. These feelings are between ('I') and ('I'): In any relationship, it is the person's Self (I) that is related to the other person's Self (I). The body is only a means to express our relationship. For example, in a mother and a child, it is the Self of the mother and the Self of the child who feel connected. Their bodies are incapable of understanding or having feelings.

3. These feelings in the ('I') are definite. i.e. they can be identified with definiteness: The feelings in a relationship between "I" and "I" such as Trust, Respect, Affection etc., can be identified with clarity. These feelings are the values which characterize any relationship.

4. Recognizing and Fulfilling these feelings lead to Mutual Happiness in a relationship: Once we recognize the values essential for any relationship, we start working and behaving according to these feelings. We begin evaluating ours' and others' feelings in the relationship. Thus living with these values leads to mutual fulfillment and happiness in all our relationships.

Present Scenario: Differentiation (Disrespect) in relationships on the basis of body, physical facilities, or beliefs –

Respect means accepting individuality and doing right evaluation (to be evaluated as I am). Our basis for respect today is largely quite contrary to our discussion above. Instead of respect being a basis of similarity or one of right evaluation, we have made it into something on the basis of which we differentiate i.e. by respecting you mean you are doing something special, because you are special or have something special or are in some special position. Thus, all of us are running around seeking respect from one another by trying to become something special.

Today, we are differentiating in the name of respect. We either differentiate people on the basis of their body, on the basis of their wealth and possessions or on the basis of their beliefs. There is no notion of respect in terms of right evaluation. Thus, there is no real feeling of relationship, only one of differentiation.

On the basis of body

- ***Sex/gender:*** We ignore the fact that being male or female is an attribute of the body, and not an attribute at the level of 'I'. And differentiate in giving respect on the basis of gender called male and females. In many countries, people even prefer a male child to a female child, and in some other societies, the other way round.
- ***Race*:** If the person is of the same race as oneself, then we treat them differently. For example, we differentiate on the basis of skin colour – white, brown, black etc. or on the basis of whether the person is of Aryan race, Mongolian race etc. or on the basis of caste. Again here, we don't do the evaluation on the basis of 'I', but on the basis of the body
- ***Age:*** We have notions such as 'one must respect elders'. There is no such notion as respect youngsters. Here, we see that we are again evaluating at the level of the body – age is related to the body, and not to 'I'.
- ***Physical strength:*** If someone is stronger, we again treat him/her differently. This is again at the level of the body. In fact, we think that we are respecting the other while it is fear; the fear that if we do not treat them like this, we will be harmed.

On the basis of physical facilities

- ***Wealth:*** We differentiate people because some have wealth than others. What we term as a "rich person" gets idolized. We don't even bother to find out whether such people are feeling prosperous, or if they just have wealth. This way, we are over-evaluating physical facilities first, which are just meant to fulfil the needs of the body, and then on this basis, we are wrongly identifying our relationship.
- ***Post:*** We try to respect on the basis of a person's position. The post is wrongly evaluated as the mark of a person's excellence and differentiation sets in. The post is considered important either on the basis that it gives more physical facilities or on the basis that certain positions are assumed to be important. In our education, we are trained directly or indirectly to earn posts for us to fetch respect.

On the basis of beliefs

- ***'Isms'*:** 'Ism' means any belief in terms of a 'thought-system' that we have, or that we have adopted. There are also many modern 'isms' such as capitalism, socialism, communism, etc. The people following these sets of beliefs are called capitalists, socialists, communists, and so on. The people that have adopted them or are following them have been exposed to them since childhood. Believing theirs to be the right belief. However, all beliefs, as we have seen are at the level of desires, thoughts and expectations (selections) in 'I'. There is no definiteness at this level, and hence, this becomes a cause for differentiation.
- ***Sects*:** People of one sect only consider those with a similar belief system to be their 'own' and worthy of respect. Following a particular tradition, or what we call as religion, becomes the basis of respect and disrespect in relationship.

The Problems Faced Due To Differentiation In Relationships:

Differentiation based on sex/gender: Issue of women's rights, and women protesting and demanding for equality in education, in jobs, and in peoples' representation. People are insecure and afraid of one another based on their gender.

Differentiation based on race: there are many movements and protect against racial discrimination and demands for equality, racial attacks, movements against cast discrimination has people living in fear of such racism, racist attacks, casticism and discrimination.

Differentiation based on age: Protests and movements demanding for equal rights for children on the one hand and for rights for elderly people on the other, generation gap.

Differentiation based on wealth: Class struggle and movements to do away with class-differentiation. Many people suffering from a lack of self-esteem and some even committing suicide.

Differentiation based on post: Protests against high handed government officials. At the level of the individual, leads to depression, etc.

Differentiation based on 'isms: Fights, turmoil, terrorism and war, people converting from one Ism to another in order to be able to get more respect.

Differentiation based on sects: Countless religions and sects and each sect has its own movement to ensure that there is no discrimination against people of their belief and demands for special provisions in jobs and in education.

Foundation Value and Complete Value in Human Relationship:

There are certain basic and important values in maintaining relationship. These values, we all know, are the backbone of health and happy family relations. The feelings, emotions, sentiments and respect all are of real importance. These values lead to elimination of friction and establishment of total harmony in relationship on long term basis. Values that are important in any relationship are:

Feelings / Values in Relationships	
S.No.	**Feeling**
1	Trust / Visvasa
2	Respect / Sammana
3	Affection / Sneha
4	Care / Mamata
5	Guidance / Vatsalya
6	Reverence / Shraddha
7	Glory / Gaurava
8	Gratitude / Kritagyata
9	Love / Prema

The Comprehensive Human Goal comprises of four constituents namely:

1. Right Understanding (Samadhana) In every individual
2. Prosperity (Samriddhi) In every Family
3. Fearlessness / Trust (Abhaya/Vishwas) In Society
4. Co-existence (Sah-astitwa) In Nature

All the above four constituents form the Comprehensive Human Goal in the same sequence as above.

Right Understanding (in individuals) – We have only information and skills, no right understanding, no true happiness.
Prosperity in Families – We forgot that the need for physical facilities is limited and are trying to generate only more and more wealth.

- Our economy, education, market is all luring us to generate more wealth.
- We are interested in the lists of millionaires and trillionaires in our society and not in the lists of prosperous people.
- We give importance to sensory enjoyment and are forgetting that wealth is needed only for keeping our body healthy.

Fearlessness/Trust in Society – We are working for strategic power and not fearlessness (In the name of defence, we are misusing the valuable resources of nature to make weapons and ammunition). Thus, we are becoming more fearful (of wars, fights etc.). We have organizations like the UNO, but we don't have programs to ensure trust among people.
Co-existence (with Nature) – We are not giving importance to co-existence with nature and are figuring out ways to exploit Nature.
(The goal of our technological development is to get victory over Nature, to subjugate the entities in nature and to disrupt nature's cycles for our whims and fancies.

Programs needed to achieve the Comprehensive Human Goal: The five dimensions of Human Endeavour
In order to achieve the Comprehensive Human Goal, the following five dimensions of Human Endeavour are to be shaped and implemented in the society:

1. Education – Right Living (Siksha – Sanskar)
(leads to Right Understanding, Right Feelings and an all compassing solution,Samadhana)
Education = To understand Harmony at all four levels of living)
Right Living = Commitment and Preparedness to live in harmony at all four levels of living
The goal and objective of education is to ensure Right Understanding, Right Feelings and An-encompassing Solution(Samadhana) in every individual through Right Living.

2. Health – Self Regulation (Svasthya – Sanyama)
(leads to Prosperity)
Health = Harmony among the parts of the body and having a fit body which acts according to the needs of the Self "I"
Self-Regulation = A feeling of responsibility for nurturing, protecting and rightly utilizing the body. Self-regulation is the basis of Health.

3. Justice – Preservation (Nyaya – Suraksha)
(leads to Fearlessness and Co-existence)
Justice = Human-Human Relation (relationship between human beings) – its recognition, fulfilment, evaluation – leading to mutual happiness
Preservation = Human – Rest of the Nature Relation – its recognition, fulfilment, evaluation – leading to mutual Prosperity
Preservation involves ensuring the following three aspects:
1. **Enrichment** – (I cultivate wheat; this enriches wheat as the quantity grows)
2. **Protection** – (I protect it so that it is fit to eat)
3. **Right Utilization** – (I use it for the nurturing of the body and do not let it get wasted)

4. Production – Work (Utpadana – Karya)
(Leads to Prosperity and Co-existence)
Production = Things obtained out of work
Work = Labour that a human being does on the rest of the Nature
Two important questions come to our mind when we talk of Production – Work :
1. What to produce?
2. How to produce?
We should decide **what to produce** depending on the right identification of needs for the right utilization of the body.
How to produce refers to the technology or systems we use for production. In Nature,
1. The systems are cyclic and not open ended. For eg. Water cycle, Nitrogen cycle, Food chain etc.
2. The systems are mutually fulfilling and mutually enriching. For eg. When birds, animals or humans eat guavaswhich come from nature, finally they go back to nature(soil) itself through excreta. Hence we should design our production systemsinsuch a way that the mutual fufilment in nature is ensured and not disturbed.
5. Exchange – Storage (Vinimaya – Kosa/ Kosh)
(leads to Prosperity and Fearlessness)
Exchange = Exchanging of produce for mutual fulfilment and not for madness of profit
Storage = Storing of produce after the fulfillment of needs with a view of right utilization in future and not for hoarding.

Harmony from Family Order to World Family Order: Universal Human Order
Once we understand the Comprehensive Human Goal and the five dimensions of Human Endeavour, in the light of Right Understanding, our Natural Acceptance extends from the level of Individual to the levels of Family and then Society and finally into a feeling of World Family. This forms the basis of an undivided society (Akhanda Samaj) a feeling of relatedness for all (we are all one family). Thus, when we expand into a world family, we realize our responsibility in the society and participate in it.

Undiveded Society (Akhanda Samaja) – feeling of being related to every human being
Universal Human Order (Sarvabhauma Vyavastha) – feeling of being related to every unit including human beings and other entities of nature.

Unit – 4 Harmony in the Nature and Existence

Nature: Natural/ Physical / Material world (or) entire Universe

Four orders in Nature:
Everything around us can be placed under the following 4 orders –

1. **Material order – Padartha / Vastu avastha**
It includes the soil, metals, compounds, liquids, gases etc (on earth) and the stars, planets, moon etc(beyond earth)
2. **Plant/ Bio order – Prana avastha**
It includes all flora such as grass, trees, seeds, fruits, flowers, parasitic plants, carnivorous plants
3. **Animal order – Jiva order**
It includes all the animals, birds and insects (from unicellular to complex animals)
4. **Human / Knowledge order – Gyana avastha**
It includes all the human beings (Body + I)

Interconnectedness and Mutual fulfilment between the four Orders (Parasparata and Paraspara Purakata):

Material Order, Plant Order, Animal Order:

Material Order helps the Plant and Animal Order by providing soil, water, oxygen, sunlight, nutrients, minerals etc. and also provides the basis for movement.

Plant Order helps the Material Order by preventing soil erosion, producing Oxygen, absorbing CO2 etc. It helps the Animal Order by providing food.

Animal Order helps the Material Order by enriching the soil through excreta. It helps the Plant Order in Pollination.

Thus all the three orders are mutually interdependent and co-exist with mutual fulfilment.

Material Order, Plant Order, Animal Order, Human Order:
All the first three orders help the Human Order to have the Natural Acceptance to be mutually fulfilling with the three orders. But human beings are not able to ensure this fulfilment.

The Material Order helps the Human Order by providing soil, minerals, metals, oxygen etc. but Human beings in return are polluting the Material Order and depleting the fossil fuels.

The Plant order helps the Human order by proving food, oxygen and by absorbing Carbondioxide. In return, the Human beings are destroying forests and many species of plants and herbs.

The Animal order provides the Human order with food, wool, leather, means of labour and transport etc. The Human beings in return have made several species of animals extinct.

Thus, except the Human order, all the other three orders are in harmony with each other and are

also fulfilling the Human order. It is high time that the human beings learn to live in harmony with the other three orders.

Recyclability and Self-regulation in Nature:
Cyclical/Recyclability and **Self-regulation** are the two characteristics of Nature.
Cycles such as Food chain, Water cycle, Nitrogen and Carbon cycles help in regulating –

- pollution (through decomposition of dead organisms in forests etc)
- changes in seasons to promote birth and death and regulate overgrowth of plants etc.
- food chain controls over population of plants as well as animals
- balance in male and and female species disturbed by the Human Order
- compensating for the loss of nutrients from soil through decomposed matter.

Salient aspects of the Four Orders:

ORDER	MATERIAL	PLANT/BIO	ANIMAL	HUMAN
Things (Vastu)	Soil, Air, Water	Plant Body	Animal Body + "I"	Human Body + "I"
Activity (Kriya)	Composition/ Decomposition	(Composition/ Decomposition + Respiration) in Body	(Composition/ Decomposition + Respiration) in Body + (Selection) in "I"	(Composition/ Decomposition + Respiration) in Body + (Selection, Thought, Desire) in "I" + (Need for Realization & Understanding)
Innateness (Dharana)	Existence	(Existence + Growth) in Body	(Existence + Growth) in Body + (Will to Live) in "I"	(Existence + Growth) in Body + (Will to Live with Happiness) in "I"
Natural Characteristic (Svabhava)	Composition/ Decomposition	(Composition/ Decomposition + Nurture/Worsen) in Body	(Composition/ Decomposition + Nurture/Worsen) in Body + (Non-cruelty/Cruelty) in "I"	(Composition/ Decomposition + Nurture/Worsen) in Body + (Perseverance, Bravery, Generosity) in "I"
Basic Activity (Kriya)	Recognising, Fulfilment	Recognising, Fulfilment	(Recognising, Fulfilment) in Body + (Assuming, Recognising, Fulfilment) in "I"	(Recognising, Fulfilment) in Body + (Knowing, Assuming, Recognising, Fulfilment) in "I"
Conformance (Anu-sangita)	Constitution conformance	Seed conformance	Breed conformance	Right Values conformance

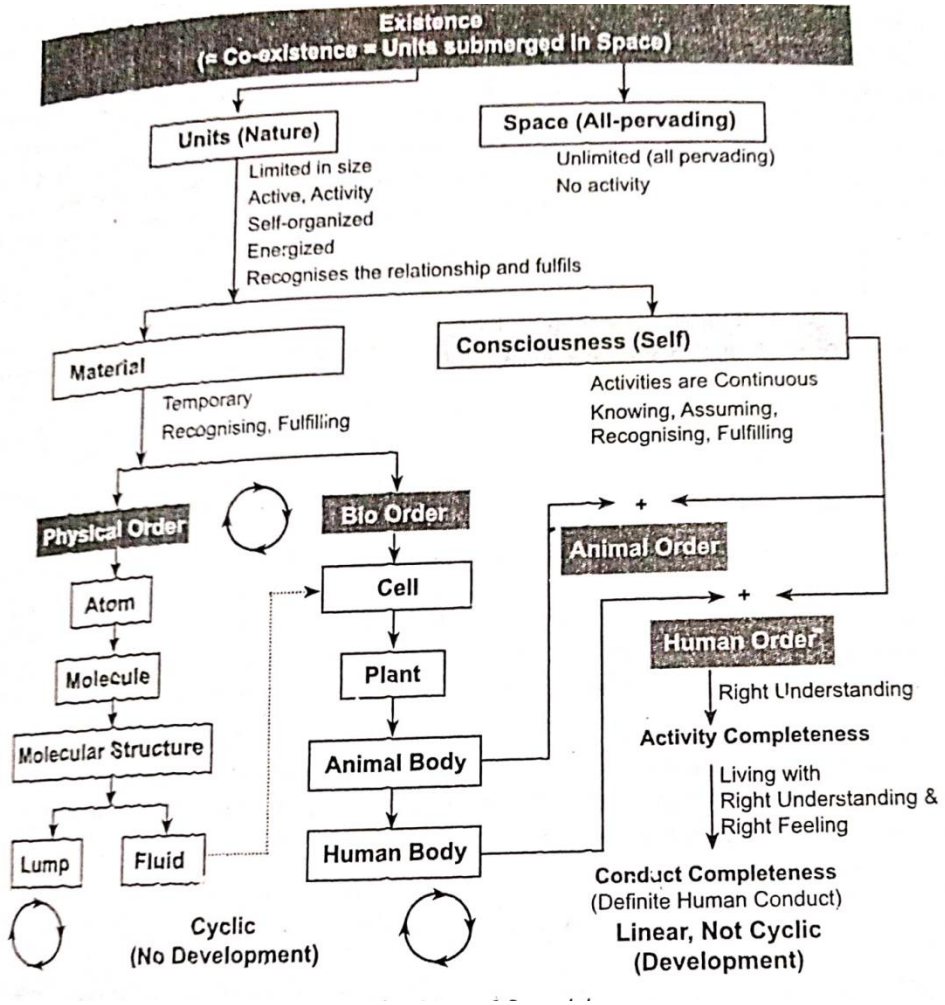
UNIT (ikai) : All the things in nature are called units. All units big or very small are limited in size. For Example, a small blade of hair to the large galaxies (each unit occupies limited amount of space and has a boundary and is countable).

SPACE(Sunya/Shoonya) = empty space found everywhere, For example : What is there between you and your book? Nothing. This "Nothing" or empty space is called Shoonya or Space. Space is not a unit. It can't be touched, smelled or seen. We can just see through it. Space exists everywhere.

EXISTENCE

All the units of all orders in nature, along with the empty space constitute the Existence. Hence, **Existence = Space + Units (in space).** We can also say that all the units of all the orders 'exist in space', 'are in space' and 'submerged in space'. Therefore **Existence = Nature submerged in space**. Being in space, all the units in nature, lead to the **Complete Existential Order**
Existence = Co-existence = Units submerged in space

<u>DIAGRAM SHOWING VARIOUS ATTRIBUTES OF UNITS AND SPACE:</u>



UNIT-5 Implications of the above Holistic Understanding of Harmony on Professional Ethics

VALUES IN DIFFERENT DIMENSIONS OF HUMAN LIVING

The participation of human beings at different levels in the larger order is our "Value". This participation is seen in two forms: **Behaviour and Work.**

VALUES PERTAINING TO BEHAVIOUR

These are the nine values in a relationship namely trust, respect, care, affection, guidance, reverence, glory and love.

VALUES IN THE INTERACTION OF HUMAN BEINGS WITH MATERIAL THINGS

Material Things have two Values:

1. Utility Value (Upayogita Mulya) and

2. Artistic Value (Kala Mulya)

Anything useful to us has utility value like a shirt, pen etc. The way these things are designed for convenience, attractive look etc. constitutes their Artistic Value.

Universal Values Naturally Emerging from the Right Understanding

There is an innate harmony and orderliness in the existence. Human beings just need to understand it (not create). This Right Understanding of the harmony helps in inculcating the universal values. The Universal Values are the truths of existence and are always there. They should not be enforced through fear, greed or blind faith/belief. The values are naturally acceptable and there is no need for imposition or enforcement.

ETHICAL HUMAN CONDUCT

Values: desirable or useful qualities in a person

Morals : knowing what is right and what is wrong after reading/observing/experiencing something

Moral Values: the relative values that give us protection and respect if used correctly.
Example: courage, commitment etc.

Ethics = moral values in action
(knowing the difference between right/ wrong usage of morals and doing the right thing even if it is risky or painful)

Ethical Human Conduct = Behaviour which is ethically correct. It is self-satisfying, people-friendly, eco-friendly and universal.

Examples of Ethical Values = eg. Keeping promise, honesty, loyalty, fairness, concern for others, commitment, abiding by law etc.

Good Professional = A person having Ethical Human Conduct + requisite Professional Skills

Professional Ethics = The personal, official or business rules that govern our behaviour within the context of a particular situation
Eg. Ethics in border security, lawyers, doctors in the gender testing of the foetus etc

The Right Understanding gained through Self Exploration enables us to identify the definitiveness of human conduct, also called, the Ethical Human Conduct.

DEFINITIVENESS OF ETHICAL HUMAN CONDUCT

The definitiveness of ethical human conduct is understood in terms of definiteness of values, policies and character and it is universal.

1. **Values(Mulya)** – they are part of our Ethical conduct and are the outcome of our realization and understanding. They are always definite(30 in number).

There are 30 Values in all for a human being:

Within the Self (in "I") – 4 Values
Sukha(Happiness), Santi(Peace), Santosa(Satisfiction), Ananda(bliss)

As a human being, in participation in the universal order – 6 Values
Perseverance(Dhirata), Bravery(Virata), Generosity(Udarata), Kindness(Daya), Beneficience(Kripa), Compassion(Karuna)

In human relationships with other human beings – 18 Values
Trust(Viswasa), Respect(Sammana), Affection(Sneha), Care(Mamata), Guidance(Vatsalya), Reverence(Shraddha), Glory(Gaurava), Gratitude(Kritagyata), Love(Prema), Complimentariness(Soujanyata), Compliance (Souhardra), Commitment (Nista), Generosity(Udarata), Spontaniety(Sahajata), Obedience(Pujyata), Ease(Saralata), Self-restraint(Saumyata), Unanimity(Ananyata)

Human beings in interaction with rest of the nature – 2 Values
Utility Value(Upayogita mulya), Artistic Value(Kala mulya)

2. **Policy(Neethi)** – It refers to developing an ethical sense in all our pursuits and think, behave and work towards nurturing this harmony. It is a manifestation of right understanding in deciding upon the enrichment, protection and right utilization of the three resources namely, Mana (mind), Tana (body) and Dhana (wealth).(3 in number)

- Economic Policy (Artha niti) – policy for enrichment of wealth
- Political Policy (Rajya niti) – policy for protection of body and wealth
- Policy for Universal Human Order (Dharma niti) – policy for the right utilization of mind, body and wealth.

3. **Character(Charitra)** – definiteness of our living and character(3 in number)

- Chastity in Conjugal relationship(husband-wife relationship)
- Rightful production, acquisition and utilization of wealth
- Humane behaviour and work with kindness

This definitiveness of human conduct in terms of values, policies and character is termed as Ethics.

A human being with ethical human conduct coupled with requisite professional skills becomes a good professional like a good doctor, a good teacher etc.

- Ethical conduct should be naturally acceptable to us and should not give rise to conflicts within.
- It should be in consonance with the right understanding of the reality.
- It should lead to mutual fulfilment with other people and mutual enrichment with rest of the nature.
- It should be self-satisfying, people-friendly, eco-friendly and universal.

IMPLICATIONS OF VALUE-BASED LIVING

1. **At the level of Individual:** Getting rid of frustration, depression, conflicts etc. and developing good health, happiness and prosperity

2. At the level of Family: reduced family feuds, feeling of togetherness, the feeling to nurture others, living on the basis of human consciousness and not on the basis of animal consciousness.

3. At the level of Society: relationships get higher priority over physical facilities leading to increase in fearlessness and mutual trust, differentiations based on the body, physical facilities, beliefs will get reduced, conflicts between communities, nations, races etc. will get reduced, problems of naxalism, terrorism, war etc. will be solved, feeling of undividedness will be developed leading to the fulfillment of the common human goal.

4. At the level of Nature: Problems of pollution, resource depletion, ecological imbalance etc. will be solved, better methods of farming and production will be found, afforestation will be done and animals will be protected from being extinct.

Profession: The participation of human beings in the larger order to pursue the Comprehensive Human Goal

→ It is a participation involving production and production related activities. It helps to provide physical facilities for oneself and one's family.

Professional Education: The education which helps to acquire the specific skills and knowledge for any profession

Professional Ethics (also called Ethical Conduct of Profession) : right utilization of one's professional skills

→ A competent professional should carry out his profession with Right Understanding, Dexterity and Commitment. His efforts should be conducive to human welfare, to the happiness and prosperity of everyone and to the enrichment of nature.

To have competence in professional ethics, one should have:

- Clarity about the Comprehensive Human Goal
- Confidence in yourself and in harmony at all levels
- Competence of mutually fulfilling behaviour with ethical conduct
- Competence of mutually enriching interaction with nature
- Competence of actualizing/ implementing of one's understanding

Issues in Professional Ethics – The Current Scenario

Issues such as Corruption, Tax evasion, Cut-throat competition, Consumer Exploitation, Adulteration, Endangering Public Health and Safety, Hoarding (accumulating) and Overcharging, Unethical Advertisements and Sales Promotions etc.

Examples:

→ Bhopal Gas Tragedy, Chernobyl Disaster
→ Hawala and Benami transactions
→ Drug mafia, Builders' mafia, Arms mafia
→ Promoting harmful products like Pan masala etc.

The way out:

→ Introducing Awareness Programmes, New Courses, Case Studies
→ By administering Oaths & Prescribing Codes of ethical Conduct for professions.
→ Carrying out intensive audits
→ Implementing strict laws and harder punishments
→ Carrying out "Sting Operations"
→ Encourage whistle blowing by Individuals and Groups

Inherent Contradictions and Dilemmas:

Several businesses follow the policy " Your loss is my gain"

Examples:

→ Cigarettes, Gutkas, Pan-masalas are advertised in a glamourous, tempting manner but come with Statuatory Warnings such as " Injurious to Health"etc.

→ The professions of Doctors, Lawyers, Defence Personnel etc.

Often, the common man's question is: Should we buy them or Should we not?

Such contradictions and dilemmas occur due to prime focus on profit maximization.

The only solution to all such dilemmas is RIGHT UNDERSTANDING.

Holistic = a belief that all parts are interconnected to form a whole (dealing with the whole rather than the individual units)

Vision of Holistic Alternative = choosing to deal with the whole rather than with individual units

Basis of Humanistic Education & Humanistic Constitution

Implimentation of Right Understanding leads to change in education system(humanistic education) (thus)Education changes from mere reading, writing, arithmetic to understanding and developing harmony at all levels.

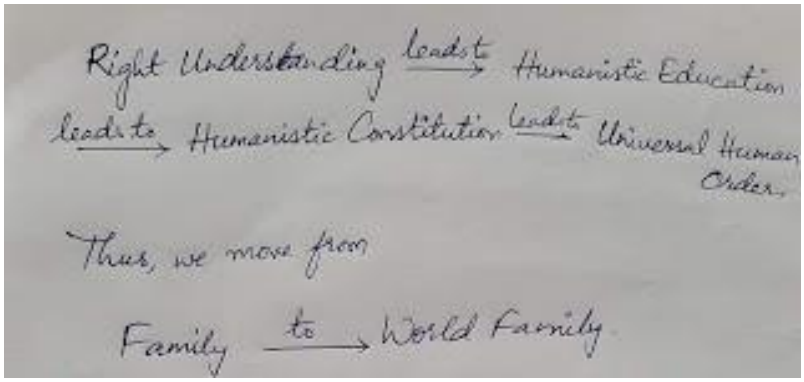
Humanistic Education

- emphasizes on self exploration
- leads to self evolution
- enables to realize innateness (svatva)
- changes the entire education systems in the long run
- to develop such education, lot of research effort is needed to develop new models

Humanistic Constitution

- Refers to the creation of clear guidelines & policy framework to safe guard social justice (wiping out caste, religion. Economic bias etc) and to develop a universal human order
- Subsides conflicts ranging from family level to global level

Universal Human Order and its Implications



The Holistic Criteria for Evaluation:

There are three broad criteria to guide the development of technologies and systems conducive to human welfare:

1. Catering to appropriate needs and lifestyles
2. People friendly
3. Eco friendly

More specifically, it can be described as follows:

Criteria for technologies –

- Catering to real human needs
- Compatible with natural systems and cycles
- Facilitating effective utilization of human body, animals, plants and materials
- Safe, user friendly and conducive to health

- Producible with local resources and expertise as far as possible
- Promoting the use of renewable energy resources
- Low cost and energy efficient
- Enhancing human interaction and cooperation
- Promoting decentralization
- Durability and life cycle recyclability of products

Criteria for Production Systems

- What to produce?
- How to produce?
- For whom to produce?
- And how much to produce?

Criteria to judge the appropriateness of production systems

- Optimal utilization of local resources and expertise
- Economic viability and sustainability
- Priority for local consumption
- Matching the pattern of production with the availability/producibility in the local environment and the pattern of consumption
- Decentralized systems capable of meaningful employment of people in the community
- Facilitating production by masses and not mass production in a centralized mode
- Promoting individual creativity and sense of accomplishment
- Using people-friendly and eco-friendly technologies
- Ensuring requisite quality of production
- Safe and conducive to health of persons involved in production as well as to others.

Criteria for Humanistic Management Models

- The whole unit working as a well-knit family
- Cooperative and motivational
- Ensuring correct appraisal of human labour
- Targeting employer-employee as well as consumer satisfaction and not profit maximization
- Sharing of responsibility and participative mode of management
- Continuous value addition of the persons involved
- Effectively integrating individual competencies and complimentarity

Steps for transition at the level of Family, Society and Profession:

Promoting Mass Awareness and Moving Towards Humanistic Education: The most crucial step to affect transition in the society is by creating mass awareness and by motivating people for self-exploration. This awareness can be brought about through personal interaction, popular literature, formal courses, workshops and seminars at various levels like schools, colleges, professional institutions etc.

Evolving Holistic Models of Living : It is necessary to develop holistic models of living such as the development of holistic technologies, production systems, and management models to to actualize the holistic ways of life.

Amending Policies, Programs and Social Systems in Tune with Comprehensive Human Goal: All our policies, programs, technologies and professions as well as the economic, political and social systems need to be gradually modified to suit the holistic worldview.

Is the Transition too Difficult?

It is often said that the vision for holistic alternative is idealistic and very difficult to achieve. But it is a wrong notion. Even small steps towards right understanding are very soothing, mutually fulfilling and confidence giving. The more we explore within ourselves, the more we develop the understanding and realization for the need of the holistic alternatives.

Conclusion

To ensure continuous happiness and prosperity in the human order, the transition to human consciousness is required. To bring about this transition towards the holistic alternative, it is necessary to create mass awareness and facilitate wide spread humanistic education. Also, extensive research has to be done to evolve and implement holistic technologies and systems. It is also necessary to make appropriate amendments in the policies, programs and social systems to facilitate the transition.